

COLD OUTREACH TEMPLATE GUIDE

COLD OUTREACH TEMPLATES

Every email and DM template you need to pitch brands and get deals: the first message, the follow-up, and what to say at all stages of the conversation.

INSIDE

01. How to pitch brands

03. Follow-ups and replies

05. Niche pitch lines

02. Cold email templates

04. Cold DM templates

01 · HOW TO USE THESE TEMPLATES

HOW TO PITCH BRANDS

Read this before you start sending. Your pitch isn't about you. It's about the value you could create for the brand.

KEEP IT SHORT AND SPECIFIC

You don't need a long paragraph about your background. Don't hit them with a wall of text that triggers them to automatically dismiss your email. Show the brand you understand their marketing, see an opportunity, and have an idea that serves a purpose.

SELL THE VALUE, NOT YOUR LIFE STORY

The brand is thinking: what can you do for me? Shift from "here's why I'm great" to "here's what I noticed and what I could create to help you."

EVERY PITCH HAS FOUR PARTS

01.

Introduction

Who you are and why you're reaching out. Keep it brief.

02.

Content idea

One specific idea or observation that proves you looked at the brand.

03.

The benefit

Why it helps them. What problem it solves or what it could accomplish.

04.

Portfolio

An immediate way to see your work and decide if you're a fit.

WHAT TO AVOID

- **Generic pitches.** "I love your brand and would love to collaborate" tells them nothing.
- **Your life story.** Skip the long intro. Get to the point.
- **No actual idea.** Give them a reason to respond.
- **Rates too early.** Get the "I'm interested" first. Talk money second.

BEST PRACTICE

- **Pitch the decision maker.** Find the person who hires creators, not just the main brand account.
- **Check if they use UGC.** It decides which template you send.
- **Keep it short.** Your email should ideally be around 100 words. Less than 150.
- **Pace your sending.** Max ~30 emails per day per email account.
- **Follow up.** Most replies come after the second touch.

MAKE IT YOUR OWN

Do not just copy and paste. Personalize every message to the brand, the product, and the opportunity. If everyone sends the same script, brands notice.

02 · COLD EMAIL

COLD EMAIL

Three versions for three situations. Pick the one that fits the brand, then make it yours.

EMAIL SUBJECT LINE

01. UGC Video Concept for [Brand Name]

02. Content Idea for [Brand Name]

03. Partnership with @yourusername

WHICH VERSION TO SEND

01. **GENERAL COLD EMAIL**
Your go-to pitch for any brand. Use it when you haven't dug into how they market yet.

02. **BRAND ALREADY USES UGC**
They already want creator content. You don't need to sell them on UGC, just on you. Usually a faster close.

03. **BRAND DOESN'T USE UGC**
Mostly polished brand content, product photography, or traditional ads. More education needed, and potentially more opportunity.

HOW TO CHECK

Look at their organic socials, then search the brand in the Facebook Ads Library and select All Ads to see what they're running.

02 · COLD EMAIL · VERSION 1

GENERAL COLD EMAIL

WHEN TO USE Your default first touch. Works for any brand you want to pitch.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

SUBJECT UGC Video Concept for [Brand Name]

Hi [Name/Team]!

I'm [Your Name], a UGC creator specializing in [your niche].

I [came across / am a big fan of] [Brand Name] and was really drawn to [specific product, campaign, or something you noticed about the brand].

I have an idea for a [specific video concept] featuring [product] that could help [specific benefit, such as showcasing the product, reaching new audiences, or driving conversions].

[OPTIONAL: If relevant, include:] I've previously worked with [relevant brands] in the [industry] space!

Here are a few examples of my work. [Embed Portfolio Link]

Would you be open to hearing more about the idea? Looking forward to hearing from you!

Best,

[Your Name]

[Email / Contact Information]

[Portfolio Link]

EXAMPLE

SUBJECT UGC Video Concept for Summer Fridays

Hi Summer Fridays Team!

I'm Sarah, a beauty and lifestyle UGC creator!

I'm a big fan of Summer Fridays and was especially excited about your new Lip Butter Balm shades!

I have an idea for a "what's in my everyday bag" video featuring the Lip Butter Balm as a daily essential. I think this could be a great way to showcase the product naturally while connecting with your target audience.

I've previously created content for beauty brands like [Brand 1] and [Brand 2]! Here are a few examples of my work. [Embed Portfolio Link]

Would you be open to hearing more about the idea? Looking forward to hearing from you!

Best,

Sarah

[Email Address]

[Portfolio Link]

02 · COLD EMAIL · VERSION 2

IF THE BRAND ALREADY USES UGC

WHEN TO USE

You've looked at the brand's social media or ads and noticed they already work with UGC creators. Check their organic socials and the Facebook Ads Library to see if they're running ads or UGC-style content.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

SUBJECT UGC Video Concept for [Brand Name]

Hi [Name/Team]!

I'm [Your Name], a UGC creator specializing in [your niche].

I came across [Brand Name]'s content and noticed [specific observation about their current UGC, product, or marketing].

I had an idea for a new [specific video concept] (featuring your [product]) that could help [highlight a specific product benefit, connect with your target audience, or drive more sales].

I'd love to create this for you!

[OPTIONAL: If relevant, include:] I've previously worked with [relevant brands] in the [industry] space!

Here are a few examples of my work. [Embed Portfolio Link]

Would you be open to hearing more about the concept?

Best,
[Your Name]

EXAMPLE

SUBJECT UGC Video Concept for Glow Recipe

Hi Glow Recipe Team!

I'm Sarah, a beauty and skincare UGC creator!

I was checking out your TikTok and noticed you've been featuring creators sharing their skincare routines with your products.

I had an idea for a morning skincare routine featuring your Watermelon Glow Dew Drops, focusing on how they create that glowy, no-makeup look. I think it could be a great way to showcase the product in an authentic, everyday setting!

[OPTIONAL: If relevant, include:] I've previously worked with [relevant brands] in the [industry] space!

Here are a few examples of my work. [Embed Portfolio Link]

Would you be open to hearing more about the concept?

Best,
Sarah

02 · COLD EMAIL · VERSION 3

IF THE BRAND DOESN'T USE UGC

WHEN TO USE

The brand mostly posts polished brand content, traditional ads, or product photography, with little creator content. You're not just pitching yourself. You're introducing a content strategy they may not be using yet.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

SUBJECT Content Idea for [Brand Name]

Hi [Name/Team]!

I'm [Your Name], a UGC creator specializing in [your niche].

I came across [Brand Name] and noticed most of your content focuses on [specific observation, such as product photography or brand-produced videos].

I think UGC-style content could be a great opportunity to showcase [product] in a more relatable, everyday setting and help potential customers visualize themselves using it.

I actually had an idea for a [specific video concept] that could help [specific benefit].

Here's my portfolio so you can see some examples of my work: [Embed Portfolio Link]

Would you be open to exploring something like this?

Best,
[Your Name]

EXAMPLE

SUBJECT Content Idea for Sunday Supply

Hi Sunday Supply Team!

I'm Sarah, a lifestyle UGC creator.

I came across your Instagram and noticed most of your content features beautiful product photography and professionally shot lifestyle images.

I think UGC-style content could be a great addition to your marketing, especially showing your umbrellas being used during real beach days!

I had an idea for a beach-day essentials video featuring your umbrella, showing how easy it is to set up and how it fits into a perfect summer afternoon.

Here's my portfolio so you can see some examples of my work: [Embed Portfolio Link]

Would you be open to exploring something like this?

Best,
Sarah

03 · FOLLOW-UPS AND REPLIES

FOLLOW UP

No reply doesn't mean no. Reply to your original email so they see the full thread.

01. FOLLOW-UP EMAIL

The brand hasn't responded. Send 3–5 business days after your first email.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

SUBJECT Re: UGC Video Concept for [Brand Name] (reply to your previous email)

Hi [Name/Team]!

Following up on my previous email!

I'd still love to explore creating content for [Brand Name]. I think the [briefly mention your concept] could be a great fit for your marketing.

Happy to share more details!

Best,
[Your Name]

02. SECOND FOLLOW-UP (OPTIONAL)

Still nothing after another 5–7 business days. Keep it light and leave the door open.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Hi [Name/Team]!

Just wanted to follow up one last time!

I'd love to bring new content ideas to [Brand Name] if you're looking for UGC creators. And if right now the timing isn't right, I'd love to reconnect down the road if the opportunity comes up.

Here's my portfolio again for easy reference: [Portfolio Link]

Thanks so much!

Best,
[Your Name]

03 · WHEN THEY ASK FOR RATES

REPLY WITH RATES + UPSELL

WHEN TO USE

A brand responds positively and asks for your rates or rate card. Turn one video into a full project by offering extra deliverables that add value to their campaign. Be clear on pricing while leaving room to discuss scope. Brands usually lowball first. They have the budget.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Hi [Name]!

Thanks so much for getting back to me! I'd love to work together.

To help you get the most value out of this content, I can put together a package with additional deliverables, giving your team more creative options and flexibility across multiple channels.

Here's a quick breakdown of my rates:

Base UGC Video: \$X

Additional Videos: \$X per video to showcase different concepts or angles

Additional Hooks: \$X per hook to test different openings and messaging

Raw Footage: \$X for additional content your team can repurpose

Additional Formats: \$X per format for use across different platforms

Paid Usage Rights: \$X for [30/60/90 days] of paid advertising

Total Package: \$X

This way, you can maximize the value of each piece of content. Would you like me to put together a custom package with these options included?

Also, do you have a specific deadline in mind for the content? I typically work with a turnaround time of [X days/weeks] after receiving the product and creative brief, which includes one round of feedback and revisions.

Talk soon!

Best,
[Your Name]

MAKE IT YOUR OWN

Swap in your real rates and only list the deliverables you actually offer. Lead with the package, not the single video. Reference our pricing cheat sheet.

03 · CLOSING THE DEAL

BUDGET + NEXT STEPS

01. IF THE BRAND SAYS THEY DON'T HAVE THE BUDGET

Hold your rates. Adjust the scope instead.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Hi **[Name/Team]**!

Thanks so much for letting me know! I completely understand.

At this stage in my UGC career, my rates are set, but I'd be happy to adjust the scope of work to find a way to still work together!

If you have a specific budget in mind, we can explore adjusting the deliverables to create a package that aligns with your budget while still meeting your campaign priorities.

Let me know what you're thinking!

Best,

[Your Name]

02. ACCEPTING A DEAL AND CONFIRMING NEXT STEPS

You've agreed on pricing and deliverables and are ready to move forward. Put everything in writing.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Hi **[Name]**!

That sounds great! I'm excited to move forward with this collaboration!

Just to confirm, here's what we've agreed on:

Deliverables: **[Number of videos, hooks, raw footage, etc.]**

Usage Rights: **[Organic/Paid, platforms, and duration]** (if applicable)

Total Rate: \$XXX

Timeline: **[Agreed feedback/revision date and final delivery date or turnaround time]**

Will your team be sending over a contract and creative brief? Also, please let me know if you have any specific creative guidelines or if I'll have full creative direction for the content.

Looking forward to getting started!

Best,

[Your Name]

04 · COLD DM · INSTAGRAM AND TIKTOK

COLD DM

Use your personal UGC account to message brands directly. See a brand you like? Pitch them.

01.

VERSION A: INITIAL DM (DIRECT PITCH)

For reaching out directly to a brand's Instagram or TikTok account.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Quick question are guys looking to expand your pool of UGC creators?

I'm [Your Name], a UGC creator specializing in [your niche]!

I [came across / am a big fan of brand name] and especially love [specific product or something you noticed about the brand/their marketing style].

I have an idea for a [specific video concept] featuring [product] that I think could [drive benefit]!

Where can i send my portfolio for you to take a look? Or can I get the email of your partnerships lead?

02.

VERSION B: INITIAL DM (REQUEST COLLABORATION EMAIL)

A softer intro. Get the right contact before you send a full pitch.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Hi [Brand Name] team! ❤️

Quick question- Can I have the email of your partnerships lead?

Thanks so much!

ACADEMY TIP

Version B works especially well with larger brands. Instead of pitching whoever runs the account, you're asking to be sent to the person who handles creator partnerships.

04 · COLD DM · LINKEDIN

LINKEDIN + FOLLOW-UP

03. INITIAL LINKEDIN DM (REQUEST EMAIL)

Go straight to the source. Search the company and message the person closest to the decision: Head of Influencer Marketing, Creator Partnerships, Social Media Manager, Marketing Manager, or CMO. Connect without immediately pitching your services.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Hi [Name]!

Reaching out regarding [brand name]. I'm [Your Name], a UGC creator specializing in [your niche].

I saw that you were the [job title] and I had an idea for a [specific video concept about product] that could help [drive benefit].

Are you the right person to connect with regarding UGC partnerships, or is there someone else you'd recommend reaching out to? I'd love to share this video concept and send over my portfolio!

Thanks so much!

04. FOLLOW-UP DM

For Instagram, TikTok, or LinkedIn. No response after about 3–5 business days.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Just checking in on my previous message!

I'd still love to share my content idea for [Brand Name] if you're open to exploring UGC style content.

Here is a link to my portfolio.

Thanks so much!

04 · COLD DM · WHEN THEY REPLY

MOVE IT TO EMAIL

05. **WHEN A BRAND EXPRESSES INTEREST**
They want to hear your idea or discuss a collaboration. Transition to email.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Hi **[Name/Team]**!

Amazing! I'd love to work together! Would you mind sharing the best email to reach you at? I'd be happy to send over my portfolio, video concepts, and rates so we can discuss the details and get things moving!

Talk soon!

06. **WHEN A BRAND ASKS ABOUT PRICING IN DMS**
They ask for your rate card or what you charge on Instagram, TikTok, or LinkedIn.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Thanks so much for getting back to me!

My rates start at **[\$XXX]** for **[type of content]**. I also offer additional hooks, raw footage, and paid usage rights depending on your campaign needs.

I can put together a custom package for you.

Would you mind sharing the best email to reach you at? I'd be happy to send over more details!

Talk soon!

07. **AFTER A BRAND GIVES YOU THEIR EMAIL**
They send the email for their marketing or creator partnerships team.

TEMPLATE

COPY + PERSONALIZE

Perfect, thank you so much! I'll reach out via email with a few content ideas and examples of my work.

Looking forward to connecting!

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Send the email and reference your DM in the opening. It turns cold outreach into warm outreach. Suggested subject: **UGC Video Concept for [Brand Name]**, then continue with the email templates in Section 02.

*"Hi **[Name]**! I recently connected with your team on Instagram, and they directed me to this email to discuss a potential UGC collaboration!"*

04 · COLD DM · PACE YOUR OUTREACH

COLD DM BEST PRACTICES

Consistency beats blasting. A little outreach every day adds up fast.

01.

NEW ACCOUNTS

For social media accounts under 30 days old, only send 5–10 DMs per day. Gradually increase as the account establishes normal activity. Keep the overall volume conservative, roughly 5–20 per day.

02.

ESTABLISHED ACCOUNTS

For accounts older than 180 days, you can safely send up to 30–50 cold DMs per day. Increase your volume gradually while monitoring for platform restrictions.

03.

SPACE THEM OUT

Don't send every message back-to-back. Spread your DMs throughout the day instead of sending them all at once.

04.

WARM UP GRADUALLY

Start small and add a few more messages every couple of days rather than jumping from 5 to 50 overnight.

DON'T BLAST DMS

Especially with newer accounts, don't send a huge number of cold DMs at once. Build your outreach volume gradually so your account doesn't get flagged or suspended for overuse.

05 · NICHE PITCH LINES

INDUSTRY SPECIFIC NICHE PITCH LINES

Optional example lines to use over email or DM. The more niche you position yourself, the better you'll be received. Customize each one to make it your own.

OUTREACH SENTENCE STRUCTURE

"Hi! I help [industry] brands [desired outcome] through authentic [content type] that addresses [specific buyer objection/pain point] and focuses on [specific purchase drivers]. If you are interested in UGC, can I send over my portfolio for you to take a look?"

	INDUSTRY	EXAMPLE PITCH LINE
01.	Skincare	"Hi! I help skincare brands increase trust with hesitant buyers through authentic testimonial content that addresses price objections and focuses on real skin concerns and visible results."
02.	Beauty / Makeup	"Hi! I help beauty brands turn product interest into purchases through authentic demo content that addresses shade, application, and performance concerns while showing how the product looks on real people."
03.	Haircare	"Hi! I help haircare brands build buyer confidence through relatable before-and-after content that addresses concerns around effectiveness and focuses on specific hair types, damage, frizz, and styling results."
04.	Health & Wellness	"Hi! I help wellness brands build credibility with skeptical buyers through relatable testimonial content that addresses effectiveness concerns and shows how the product fits naturally into an everyday routine."
05.	Fitness / Activewear	"Hi! I help activewear brands increase purchase confidence through authentic try-on and lifestyle content that addresses fit, sizing, comfort, and quality while showing how the pieces perform during real workouts."
06.	Fashion / Apparel	"Hi! I help fashion brands convert hesitant shoppers through authentic try-on content that addresses sizing and fit concerns while showing how pieces look, move, and can be styled on a real person."
07.	Food & Beverage / CPG	"Hi! I help food and beverage brands drive trial through authentic lifestyle content that addresses taste and price hesitation while highlighting flavor, convenience, ingredients, and how the product fits into everyday life."

05 · NICHE PITCH LINES · CONTINUED

MORE
NICHE

	INDUSTRY	EXAMPLE PITCH LINE
08.	Supplements	"Hi! I help supplement brands build trust with skeptical consumers through relatable routine and testimonial content that addresses effectiveness and value concerns while highlighting the product's benefits and ease of use."
09.	Apps / SaaS	"Hi! I help app brands turn curious viewers into users through relatable problem-solution content that addresses whether the app is actually worth downloading and demonstrates how it solves a specific everyday problem."
10.	Home & Cleaning	"Hi! I help home and cleaning brands drive conversions through satisfying product demos that address effectiveness and value concerns while clearly showing the product solving common household problems."
11.	Pet Products	"Hi! I help pet brands build trust with protective pet owners through authentic owner-style content that addresses safety, quality, and effectiveness concerns while showing the product being used with a real pet."
12.	Jewelry & Accessories	"Hi! I help jewelry brands increase purchase confidence through authentic styling content that addresses quality concerns while showing how pieces look, wear, and elevate everyday outfits."
13.	Baby / Parenting	"Hi! I help baby and parenting brands build trust with cautious parents through authentic parent-style content that addresses safety, practicality, and quality concerns while demonstrating how the product makes everyday routines easier."
14.	Travel / Hospitality	"Hi! I help travel and hospitality brands turn consideration into bookings through experience-driven content that addresses whether the experience is worth the price while showcasing the atmosphere, amenities, and overall guest experience."
15.	Tech / Consumer Electronics	"Hi! I help consumer tech brands make products feel easier to understand and worth the investment through authentic demos that address price and usability concerns while showing practical, real-world use cases."

MAKE IT YOUR OWN

Find your niche, adjust the outcome and objection to the brand you're pitching, then add your portfolio link.